



Bulletin of the Lions Club of Byculla

July - December 2024



The



Den



President's Address



Every action has an impact so choose wisely the impact you want to create.

According to the World Bank report, 129 million people live in extreme poverty. And every person's suffering provides an opportunity to serve.

Lions Club of Byculla presents the privilege of reaching out to a wider range of people & serve across various sections of society.

India has over 60 million homeless dogs & cats, constituting highest levels of abandonment. Abandonment of life on such a scale mirrors the depth of societal issues & severe lack of empathy & understanding for other life forces

We are the blessed ones. The ones who have enough & more for sustenance. The ones who have the ability to give, but many a times lack the intent. The arena of social service can be a self reformatory journey if we open our hearts & minds & let the Universe do its magic.

This year has been transformatory for me. The value of gratitude has taken centre stage.

The **Do Good Cookbook**, a *gratis* against donations in aid of Paediatric Cancer & Epilepsy, is compiled around the concept of gratitude & giving back to society. There are no great achievements based on the 'I' it is always the 'We' & it is what the **Do Good Cookbook** embodies. A collective effort to uplift society. Kudos to all the contributors

Debilitating & life threatening are the words used to describe these illnesses. It crumbles a family to see their child going through inconsolable suffering. Both illnesses, if treated at an early-stage help restore near normal life for these children. With these donations, we aim to walk side by side with these families & lighten their economic burden.

I hope you too walk with us on this path we have chosen.
"One of the luckiest things that can happen to you in life, is to have a happy childhood." - Agatha Christie

In Lionistic Service,

Adil Mistry
President, Lions Club of Byculla (2024-25)



From the Bulletin Editor's Desk



Dear Fellow Lions,



A big thank you to all respected Board Members, to have entrusted me the duties of Club Bulletin Editor.

Our President L. Adil Mistry is indeed going great in his Service Activities, covering areas like Childhood Cancer, Diabetes, Hunger, Humanitarian Service & Education. Thanks to his & his family's commendable work, our club produced one of the best DG's Docket of the last years. The Lion Ladies of the club too have supported Adil's wife Jinaz to come out with a comprehensive cookbook, the proceeds of which will be used for the treatment & support of Pediatric Cancer & Epilepsy.

Our Zone Chairperson. L. Adil Bhesadia, PMJF deserves a well-deserved pat on the back to have organized a wonderful Zone Social with good fellowship, food & entertainment at the West End Hotel terrace, having personally sponsored the cost of the much enjoyed entertainment program.

I am sure that the President in his report has a lot of surprises in his bag for the remaining six months of his tenure as President. In the last six months he has achieved superb results & taken the Club to glorious heights.

The up coming Fund Raising Drive in February 2025 by 1st V.P. L. Tehemton Dalal promises to be a success & will be eagerly awaited to collect ample booty for our Service Fund.

Our membership has also steadily increased since the last year & also this year too. We now stand at 95 strong!

Wishing our Club the very best in all its Humanitarian endeavors in the coming months & years.

I love to repeat our President's wise words:
"Say Less, Do More."

Khorzad Bhesadia
Bulletin Editor (2024-25)



Fabricio Oliveira
International President
Catolé do Rocha, Brazil



Dr. Patti Hill
Past International President, 1st Int. Vice President
LCIF Chairperson
Edmonton, Alberta, Canada



A.P. Singh
1st Int. Vice President
Kolkata, India



Mark S. Lyon
2nd Int. Vice President
Brookfield, Connecticut, USA



Dr. Manoj Shah
3rd Int. Vice President
Nairobi, Kenya

107th Annual Convention 2025 Orlando, Florida, USA

Know Our International President

Fabrício Oliveira of Catolé do Rocha, Paraiba, Brazil, was elected as President of Lions Clubs International at the 106th Convention, June 21-25, 2024, in Melbourne, Australia. President Fabrício is a businessman, with a Post-Graduate Degree in Business Administration (MBA) from Fundação Getúlio Vargas (FGV), and a Degree in Administration.

KNOW YOUR DISTRICT LEADERS

DISTRICT 323 1 A1 MICRO CABINET

District Governor: **Viraf K. Mistry, MJF**
Imm. Past Dist. Governor: **Dr. Jagannath G. Hegde, PMJF**
1st Vice District Governor: **Feroze K. Katrak, MJF**
2nd Vice District Governor: **CA Pawan KR Agarwal, MJF**
Principle District Secretary: **Adv. Hozefa Q. Ghadiali, MJF**
Principle District Treasurer: **Firuza E. Sena, MJF**
Principal District PRO: **Capt. Percy M. Master, PMJF**
Region Chairperson: **Veera D. Mundroina**
Zone Chairperson/Z-2: **Adil C. Bhesadia, PMJF**
Region Chairperson Activities: **Tehemton B. Dalal**

OUR CLUB: LIONS CLUB OF BYCULLA REGION 1 ZONE 2

Membership Strength on 31-12-2024: **95 Members**

President/GAT: **Adil K. Mistry**
Imm. PP/LCIF Co-Ordinator: **Adil C. Bhesadia, PMJF**
1st Vice President/GLT: **Tehmton B. Dalal**
Secretary: **Phiroze B. Javeri**
Joint Secretary: **Huned Y. Rangwala**
Treasurer: **Kersi N. Mistry**
Joint Treasurer: **Firdaus B. Minocher**



July 13-17, 2025

Convention is coming to Orlando, Florida, USA

Lions & Leos from around the world for sun, fun, service & the 107th Lions International Convention. Famous for its theme parks, exciting attractions & vacation vibes.

Orlando is a top global destination & an exciting site for our biggest event of the year.

Come celebrate service in a city that's pure magic & more!

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**This Issue of 'The Den' is sponsored by
M/s Y.A. Bhesadia, Catering Services**

Highlights: LIONS CLUB OF BYCULLA's SUCCESS STORY

Let's raise a Toast to Lions Club of Byculla's prolific success!

The reason why the Lions Club of Byculla is a Premier Club in District 3231 A1 is because all its members are stalwarts of Charitable ventures. Charity is the act of giving help, either in the form of material possessions or time to those in need without expectation of gain. It is a virtuous act that manifests compassion.

In the year 2023-24, of President L. Adil C. Bhesadia, PMJF a new **LEO Club** was established by the **Leo Extension Chairperson & then 2nd Vice District Governor, Lion Feroze Katrak, MJF**. Ample appreciation for the Club & Extension Chairperson was received from the International President, Dr. Patti Hill. In addition, Membership strength in 2023-24, under President Adil increased by leaps & bounds, as he was responsible for inducting many new members & received an Award for it. → L. Adil Bhesadia, Adv. L. Tehemton Dalal & L. Bakhyiyar Bhurucha graduated from the **District Lions Leadership Institute** where one of the faculty was our very own future DG L. Feroze Katrak.

This year, 2004-25, President Lion Adil Mistry, like the wise old Owl sitting in an oak tree, who spoke very little, has given us an apt new motto "Say Less, Do More."

Well, a lot 'More than More' has been done in these last 6 months!

This year during the October Service Month (the Lions of Byculla are active in their charitable deeds all through the month of October & not only during its first Service Week), 47 Projects were executed at a stupendous cost of around Rs 23 Lakhs!

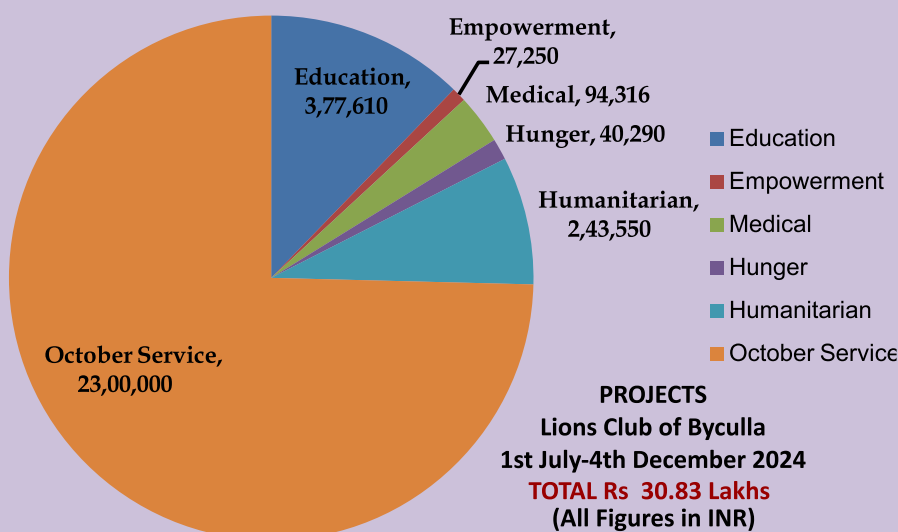
The District Governor & Micro Team's Visit was all praises for the Club & its Docket!

★ **Membership Strength is at 95 today & still hopes of growing!**

★ **47 October Service Projects worth about 23 Lakhs!**

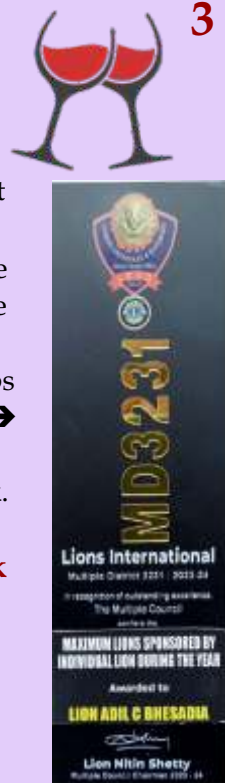
★ **Other Projects from July 1 to December 4, 2024 worth Rs 7,83,016 (7.83 Lakhs) where members contributed Rs 5,81,106 (5.81 Lakhs)!**

★ Break-up of Projects from July 1 - December 4, 2024



LITTLE WONDER THAT

**BYCULLA
ROCKS!**



OBITUARY



With heavy hearts & profound sadness, we the Lions of Byculla have lost a stalwart in **Lion Parvez (Percy) Buharivala** who left his earthly life on Friday, November 22, 2024, to begin his eternal life in heaven. He was a true Lion-hearted Lion. A beacon of kindness, charity, sincerity, with a great zest for living. A true family man, loving to his family & friends alike with traits that endeared him to all. We remember him fondly for the immense time & effort he took in pursuing all charitable projects for the Lions Club of Byculla, especially the good work done by him & his dear wife Arnie at the B.Y.L. Nair Hospital. A great model for others to follow due to his heartfelt portrayal of the spirit of a true Lion. Our condolences to his family who will undoubtedly miss him as we all will in the Lions Club of Byculla. Ending this obituary with a beautiful sentiment about Percy's impact on the lives of those around him.



PROUD MOMENTS! **A Kaleidoscope of Projects, 2024**

Physiotherapy Equipment, NAB, Mahalaxmi



Diabetes Awareness & Check up, Masina Hospital



**Lady Hirabai Cawasji Jehangir Health Unit
Tardeo, TV, Fans & Water Cooler**



**Photographic memories
of a few of the Projects**

**Slit Lamp, RNC Free Eye
Hospital, Valsad**



**Lunch & Washing Machine
Asha Sadan, Dongri**



**B.D. Petit Parsee General Hospital
Donation for Poor Patients**



**Hospital Bed,
Sir J.J. Hospital, Parsi Ward**



**Clown & Magic Show
Bai Jerbai Wadia Children's Hospital, Cancer Ward**



A GREAT IDEA FOR A WORTHY CAUSE! FUND RAISER: 'The Do-Good Cook Book' A Land Mark Fund Raiser!



We are a nearly 5-decade old Club seeped in Social Service. This year our Club has compiled a '**Do-Good Cookbook**,' in aid of Childhood Cancer & epilepsy.

Childhood Cancer & epilepsy are life threatening & debilitating. They are the top contributors of Disability Associated Life Years (DALY) & therefore deserve attention.

The Lions Club of Byculla, cognizant of the possibility of such a child's grim future have joined hands with like-minded individuals to compile a '**Do-Good Cookbook**' in aid of low-income group of children suffering from cancer & epilepsy. 100% of the proceeds will be used to support the medical needs of these children.

People from different walks of life, from home-makers to renowned caterers, to Master Chef contestants have contributed towards this deserving cause, sharing traditional family recipes to voluntarily shouldering the production of the book through various stages of its making.

We hope that you walk with us hand in hand to light up the lives of those who thought were destined to darkness, as the sale proceeds of this book will go towards the support of these children.

"Happiness is not ready-made. It comes from your own actions." - The Dalai Lama

MORE PROUD MOMENTS! Projects & Awards



5

6 Computers to Dadar Athornan Madrassa



Milk & Food Grains,
Sir J.J. Dharamshalla, Nagpada



Microwave & Mixer, Om Creations, Mahalaxmi



Blood Donation Camp, CST Railway Station



Ophthalmoscope to BYL Nair Hospital
Ophthalmic Department



Scholarships to
Vidya Integrated, Powai



Donations Parsi Infirmary, D.N. Mehta Hospital,
Bai Dosabai Kotwal Orphanage, Navsari



Avanbai Petit Girls High School, Bandra
School Bags & Wrist Watches



12 Chairs & 1st Aid Box
Bombay Institute for Deaf & Mute, Mazgaon



Sports Uniforms for Children of
Vikas Vidyalaya School for the Deaf, Dadar (W)



International President's Certificate
of Appreciation
to LCB for Fulfilling Lions International Mission



"The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others." - Mahatma Gandhi

LCIF: INSPIRING STORIES

Wishing Big for Childhood Cancer Patients

Article by: Elizabeth Edwards, September 13, 2022

(Elizabeth Edwards is a content specialist for LCIF)

Member Resource Center, Lions Clubs International



**The Lions took my wish list &
got every single one
checked off.**



With a tumor in her cheek. Her parents, Lions Tony and Stacy, began the grim routine so many families face when their children are sick. Appointment after appointment, they struggled to keep Finley entertained and distracted before an uncomfortable procedure or needle prick. **They found that games and books helped. Anything to keep her distracted.**

"Play is a great distraction for kids," says Jaime Libes, Finley's Oncologist. "It takes their minds off the needle that is about to come or the medicine that is about to make them feel sick."

Luckily, Finley was treated with an oral medication to shrink her tumor at the St. Jude Midwest Affiliate in Peoria, Illinois, USA, and now Finley is a vibrant five-year-old with a love for unicorns and playing with her big brother, AJ. The Holland family, of Silvis, Illinois, understood that they were lucky and wanted to give back to kids and families going through a cancer diagnosis. Besides Finley's tumor, cancer has personally impacted the Holland family—from Tony losing a childhood friend to cancer, and, unfortunately, knowing other parents who lost children way too soon.

That's why Tony turned to his Lions club to inspire members to donate gift cards for toys for the clinic, but he knew that he wanted to do even more. With the support of Lions Clubs International Foundation (LCIF), Tony and Stacy and Lions Dave and Cheryl Russell, decided to magnify their impact for kids with cancer.

"Treatment is a very boring process, and I wanted to help kids go through it," says Tony.

That's why they decided to update the educational and recreational resources at OSF Health Care Children's Hospital of Illinois to help "kids be kids." The St. Jude affiliate clinic is part of the OSF Children's Hospital that provides care for thousands of children throughout central Illinois.

With financial support from District 1-H, he applied for a childhood cancer grant from LCIF for US\$20,000, and a District and Club Community Impact Grant (DCG), making the total contribution to the hospital more than US\$41,000.

"When families are going through something that they can't control like childhood cancer, and we as Lions are not stepping up for them, then what are we doing as Lions?" says Tony Holland.

After applying for the grant, the Holland and Russell families turned to Allison West, a child life specialist at OSF Children's Hospital, who helps children and their families navigate the hospital setting, for a wish list. She initially only put together a small wish list for the project, but Tony told them to "wish bigger." "It is really hard to wish like that because we don't always get to wish big," says West, who used the funds to expand their ability to serve their patients. "The Lions took my wish list and got every single one checked off."

Items on the list included X box consoles, Chrome books, sensory tables, wall boards, gaming systems, educational dolls, Nintendo switches, and a custom-built playhouse retrofitted with touchscreen monitors for activities.

Not only did they donate the items, but Dave Russell built an ADA-compliant play structure in his garage and delivered it to the hospital in the spring of 2022. More than 5,000 children will have access to the playground and educational materials every year because of the combined efforts of both families, the entire Lions district and LCIF. The Holland and Russell families are forever grateful that they were able to help provide care and comfort to these little warriors.

"With the support of LCIF, we allowed the hospital staff to 'wish big' for every single child and parent who enters their doors," says Tony.

ALL ABOUT LEOS

Where There's a Need, There's a Leo

Leadership, Experience, Opportunity: That's what makes a Leo. Members of Leo clubs embody the best qualities of our incredible organization. They are devoted young people who realize the power of action. Together, Leos and Lions form a powerful partnership — one of mutual respect where Lions learn from the innovative insights of Leos, and where Leos gain access to the proven strategies of those who've successfully served the world for decades.

Why Choose Leos?: There are a lot of ways people can give back to their community, but being a Leo is much more than just service. Choosing Leo clubs will help you grow as an individual and as a leader as you join a global family of young people making the world a better place. If you're interested in joining a Leo club, use the Lions International Club Locator to find a local Leo club near you.

Developing Leaders: Leos have many leadership opportunities, including the ability to serve as Leo officers in their club, district and multiple district through annual elections. Lions International offers resources for Leos looking to grow their impact as a project organizer, motivator and leader of their peers on the club officer page, or district and multiple district leaders page. There are also in-person Lions Leadership Institutes (including the Leo Advancement Sessions) and online courses through the Lions Learning Center that Leos can access.

Lions Clubs International Membership Types

Regular: The most common membership; 1.3 million members in more than 47,000 Clubs in the world.

Family: Relatives living in the same house at a reduced rate. Children cannot become members, but can participate as Cub members, which allows children under 12 years of age.

Student: Students who are enrolled in an educational institution & are between the legal age of maturity & are under 30.

Leo: Young people interested in Lions International may become Leos as part of a Leo Club.

Leo-Lion: Former Leos who have joined the Lions organization, who are of the age of legal maturity through age 35. The transition of Leos to Lions receive a discount on dues & other benefits.

OUR DISTRICT 323 1 A1's PEACE POSTER CONTEST 2024-25

Lion Katy Daara Patel, MJF, District Chairperson, Peace Poster Contest, has genuinely made super efforts to involve all our District Clubs to participate in the Annual Peace Poster Contest of Lions Clubs International. The topic for the Poster was: '**Peace Without Limits.**' A record number of **21 Clubs** participated due to the District Chairperson Katy's efforts & **5 Posters** were selected as **District Winners** out of a total of **142 Entries**.

1st Winning Prize, LC Shivaji Park →



2nd Prize, LC B'bay Host ↑



3rd Prize, LC Sion ↑

4th Prize, LC B'bay Queensway →

(Far Right) **5th Prize, LC Byculla →→**



LIONS INTERNATIONAL PEACE POSTER WINNERS 2023-24

Grand Prize Winner, 2023-24



Fanjin Si, Age 11
LC Shanxi Datang, China

Some of the Merit Award Winners, 2023-24



Sofia Litvinova, Age 13
New Zealand



Lezé Calitz, Age 12
South Africa



Valeria Choque Quilca, Age 13
Peru



Ziying Wang, Age 13
China



Ruth Emalin Ladino Clavijo
Age 13, Columbia



Yeujin Zhao, Age 12
China



Yu Fei Yang, Age 12
Taiwan



V. Smirithi, Age 12
India



Yuxin Zu, Age 12
China



Samara Saroop, Age 12
Trinidad & Tobago



Ling Chen, Age 13
Taiwan



Maria Travisano, Age 13
Florida, USA



Alexandrea Jong Shiow Xuan
Age 12, Malaysia



Xinyu Zhao, Age 12
China